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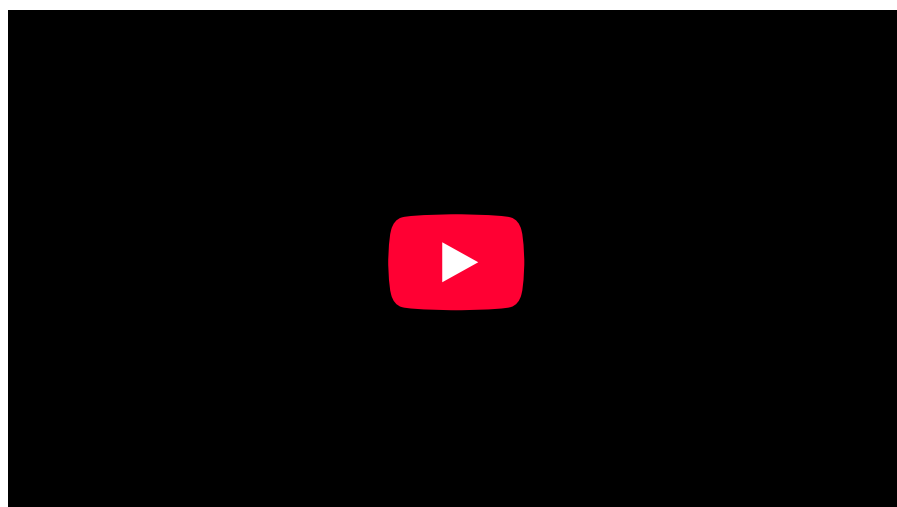
YouTube loosens profanity rules for monetized videos



YouTube is tweaking its profanity-related rules to allow creators to monetize videos with swearing in them, provided the profanity is limited to the first seven seconds of the video.

In November 2022, YouTube changed its rules so that creators who used swear words in the first 8-15 seconds would potentially be ineligible for any ad revenue. After much backlash, the company changed its rules again in March 2023 so that such videos would be eligible for limited ad revenue, unless they use profanity in the majority of the video.

Announcing the latest changes, YouTube's head of monetization, Conor Kavanagh, said in a video late on Tuesday that the changes of two years ago were made to align YouTube videos with broadcast standards.



“We introduced this guideline to align with broadcast standards; advertisers expected ads on

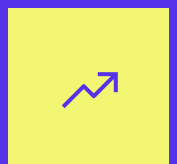
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YouTube to have a distance between profanity and the ad that just served. Those expectations have changed, and advertisers already have the ability to target content to their desired level of profanity,” he said.

He noted that if creators use moderate or strong swear words in the title or thumbnail, their videos might have limited monetization.

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Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

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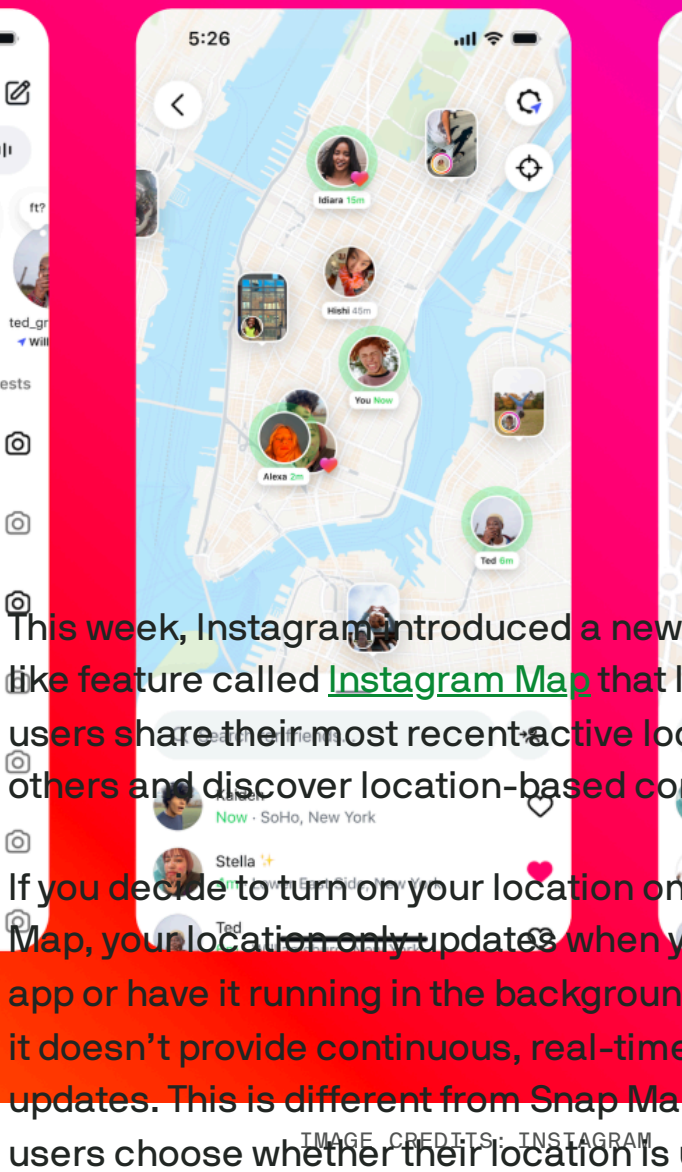
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How to use Instagram Map and set your

location-sharing preferences

Aisha Malik — 1:05 PM PDT · August 7, 2025



This week, Instagram introduced a new Snap Map-like feature called [Instagram Map](#) that lets U.S. users share their most recent active location with others and discover location-based content.

If you decide to turn on your location on Instagram Map, your location only updates when you open the app or have it running in the background, meaning it doesn't provide continuous, real-time location updates. This is different from Snap Map, which lets users choose whether their location is updated only when they open the app or in real time.

Meta says location sharing is off by default on Instagram Map. Following [concerns](#) around safety, [Instagram head Adam Mosseri](#) reassured users that the feature is opt-in, and noted that some people are “confused” about how the feature works.

For instance, people are accessing the feature and then seeing the map populated with the location information of some users. This is because the feature automatically pulls in location tags from recently posted Stories or Reels that include a tagged location.

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It's worth noting that this isn't new, as Instagram already had location tags visible to users in its map view. However, the new Instagram Map feature makes this information a lot easier to access. The new feature might make you rethink whether you want to post your Stories and Reels with location tags (especially if you're still at the location).

For those who want to ensure their location is turned off on Instagram Map, we'll walk you through the steps below.

How to access Instagram Map

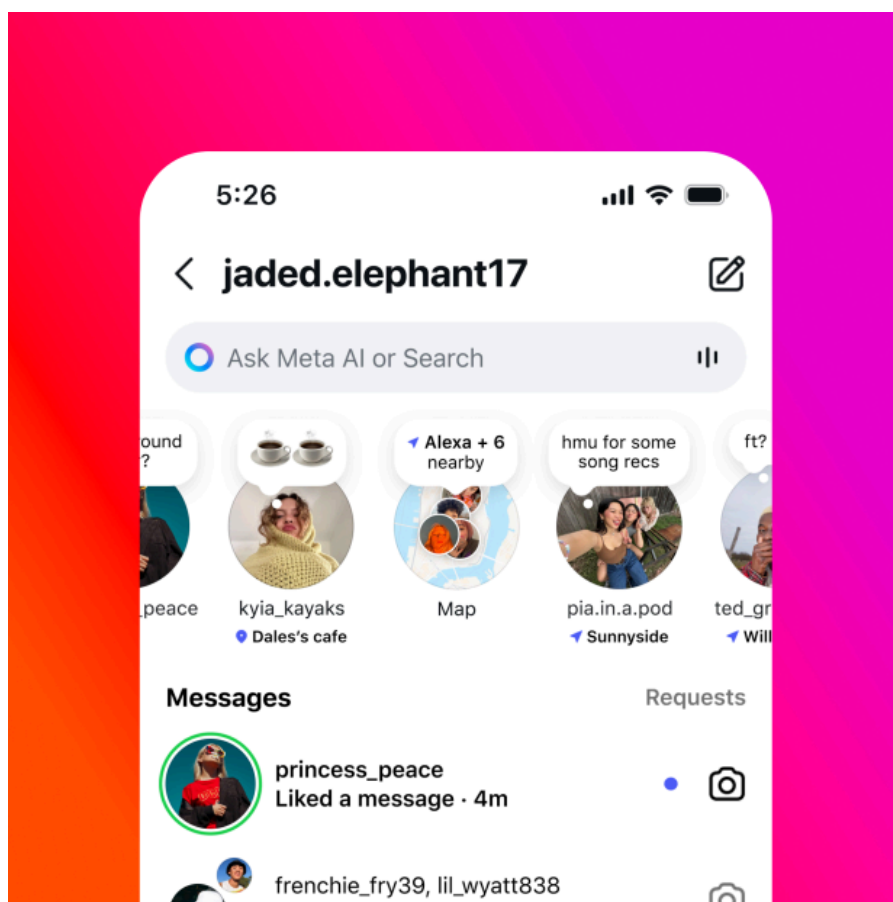


IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

To access the new feature, you need to navigate to your DMs page (direct messages) and tap the new “Map” option at the top. If it's your first time accessing the feature, you'll likely see a pop-up message notifying you about the new Map.

The pop-up will tell you that no one can see your location until you share it with them, and that you

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can change your settings at any time.

How to set your location-sharing preferences

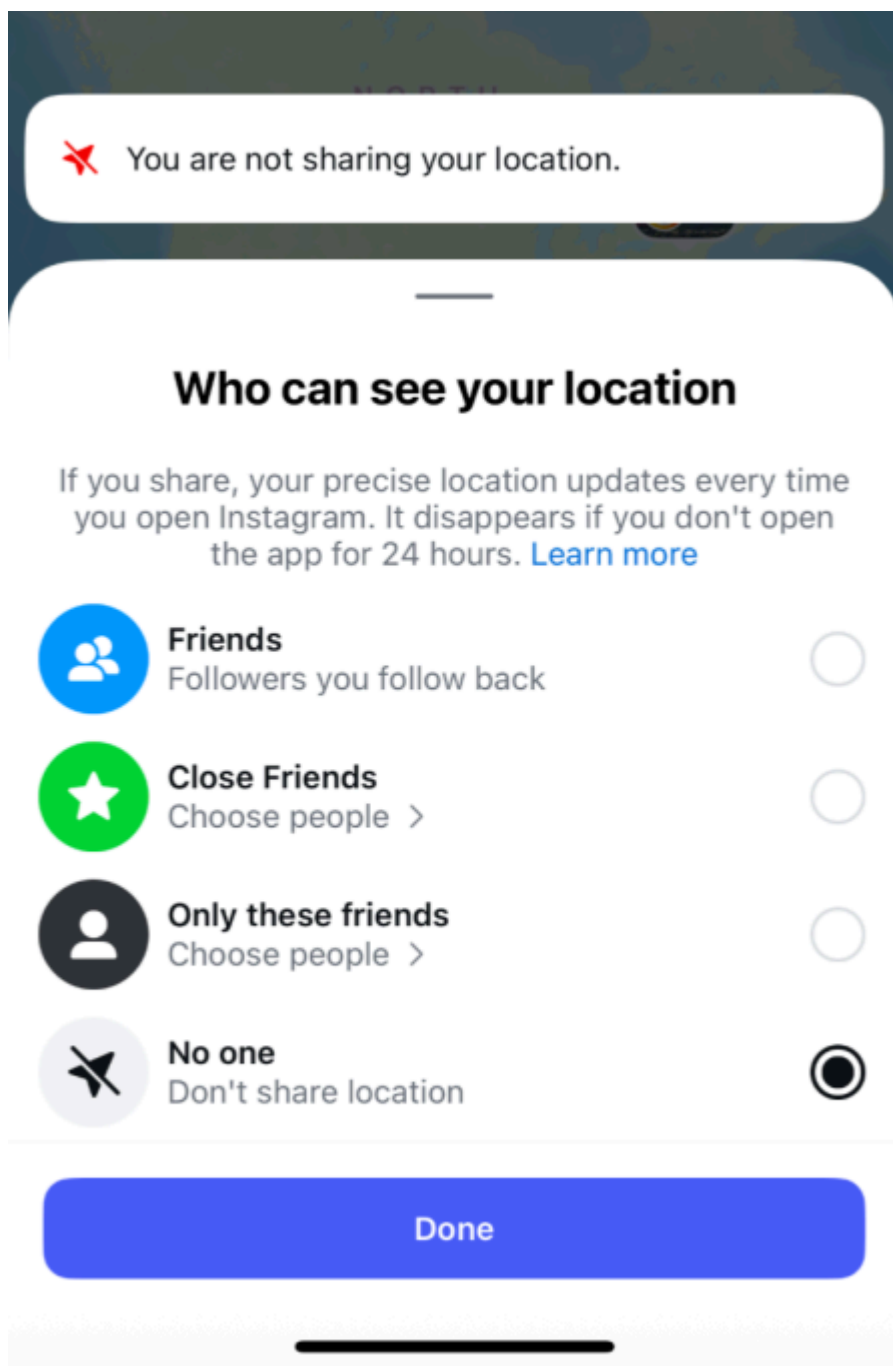


IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

The first time you open Map, you will see a page that reads “Who can see your location.” From there, you can choose to share it with your Friends (followers you follow back), your Close Friends list, select users, or no one.

To change your preferences, you need to click on your profile, tap the settings option in the top-right

corner, select the “Story, live and location” option, and then tap the “Location sharing” button. Here, you will be able to change your settings.

Note that if you have location sharing turned off, others can still share their location with you, which means you’ll be able to see them on the Map.

How to use Instagram Map

When you open the app, you will see the locations of friends who have shared their location with you. You will also see location-based Stories and Reels from people you follow.

For example, if your friend attended a nearby music festival and posted a story while there, it will appear on the map. Similarly, if a creator you follow posts a reel about a new restaurant in your city, you’ll be able to discover it on Instagram Map.

You will still see location-based content on the Map even if you have your location turned off.

You also can leave short, ephemeral messages, or “Notes,” on the map for others to see. Instagram Notes are the short messages that currently appear at the top of your direct messaging feed, but with the launch of Instagram Map, you will now see these posts on the map if they’re shared with a location.

Topics: [Apps](#) [Instagram](#) [instagram map](#) [Snap Map](#)

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Aisha Malik

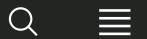
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Julie Bort — 11:52 AM PDT · August 7, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS: BREX

Financial services provider [Brex](#) on Thursday announced that it achieved a major milestone: It is now licensed in the European Union. That means it can now directly issue credit and debit cards and

Latest in Fintech

offer its spend management products to any business in all 30 EU countries with “no workarounds required,” as co-founder and CEO Pedro Franceschi wrote [in a blog post](#).

While the corporate spend management startup previously supported 60 currencies in 200 countries, it could only sell its products to companies with a U.S. presence.

With the expansion, Brex is now authorized to sell spend management (complete with issuing cards) and other tools like embedded payments to EU companies and startups, a spokesperson tells TechCrunch. However, there’s a caveat: Banking and bill pay will not be initially available. The company hopes to roll those services out in the future.

While this is good news for Brex, it may also be good news for European startups. Brex’s claim to fame is offering startups expense management cards for their employees even if they wouldn’t yet qualify from traditional banks. Without a bank account offering, the youngest EU startups will still have to weigh their options.

Next up, Franceschi says he wants to expand Brex in the U.K., though he offered no specifics on those plans.

Franceschi [said in December](#) that Brex is on track to stop burning cash in 2025, “an important milestone to our future IPO.”

In February, sources told various news outlets that Brex was on track for \$500 million in revenue this year as well. That’s quite the turnaround from a shaky moment in 2023 when Brex conducted layoffs and reportedly told employees that its cash burn was too high. There has been no hint yet as to when that IPO may take place, though.

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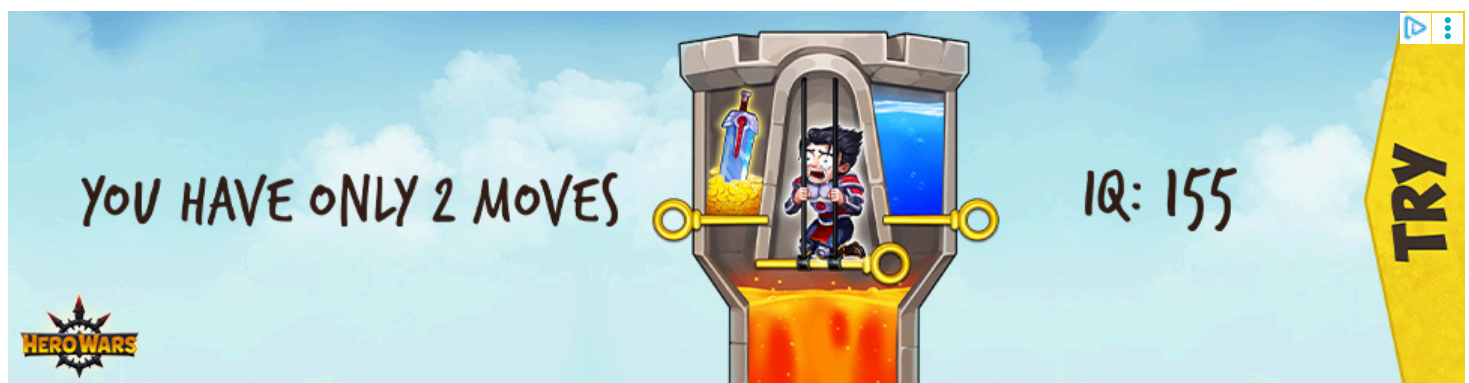
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Brex's competitive win in the international market comes as its U.S. fintech competitors are having an overall moment. Ramp has been raising money from VCs like mad, [hitting a \\$22.5 billion valuation just 45 days](#) after a round with a \$16 billion valuation. In March, [Mercury raised a fresh \\$300 million](#) and doubled its valuation to \$3.5 billion.

Brex has not publicly announced new equity VC funding since 2022, when it raised \$300 million in a [Series D-2 round at a \\$12.3 billion](#) valuation. It did, however, sell a fresh \$260 million of bonds in [March 2024](#), packaged from its spend management receivables which are used to manage that cash-intensive business.

Topics: [Brex](#) [european startups](#) [Fintech](#)

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Julie Bort is the Startups/Venture Desk editor for TechCrunch....

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IMAGE CREDITS: SPACEX

SPACE



SpaceX is building a water pipeline to Starbase — but access comes with some conditions

Aria Alamalhodaei — 10:30 AM PDT · August 7, 2025

The newest piece of infrastructure coming to Starbase, Texas, isn't a launch mount or a booster. It's a water pipeline, and who can hook up a tap (and on what terms) will shape the definition of "company town."

The new line, which will stretch from Brownsville to the newly incorporated city of Starbase, will replace the truck-hauled deliveries SpaceX has used to transport potable water for its employees and on-site residents. Brownsville Public Utilities Board (BPUB) COO Mark Dombroski confirmed the line at a July 16 meeting, saying the board had executed a

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contract with SpaceX to provide water as an in-city customer.

The BPUB approved the SpaceX contract on June 2, Dombroski told TechCrunch over email. He did not explain why SpaceX is being treated as an in-city nonresidential customer, which carries a cheaper rate class than outside-city customers, despite the fact that the company did, indeed, establish its own city.

“Under a non-standard development agreement, SpaceX will extend — at their cost — a line to a metering point within the city limits, then transport the water to Starbase,” he continued. “They will also pay for and construct the improvements needed for BPUB to deliver water to the meter. This arrangement is intended to supersede the water hauling arrangement after SpaceX starts taking water through the meter. Timing is driven largely by SpaceX’s construction schedule.”

The potable water deliveries have been constrained by a 60,000 gallons per day cap under the current hauled-water purchase agreement between BPUB and SpaceX, according to a January 2024 letter from the Texas Commission on Environmental Quality (TCEQ). The pipeline would change that, making it easier for SpaceX to build out more amenities and housing for employees.

For a handful of non-SpaceX affiliated homes, getting access to that water may come with some terms and conditions.

In July, nearly 40 properties along the stretch between Brownsville and Boca Chica were abruptly cut off from the county water service, [according to the San Antonio Express-News](#). Cameron County previously delivered fresh water as a “courtesy” service to these properties, but the county now

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says it is Starbase’s responsibility to deliver water to these residents.



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Starbase disagrees: In July, Starbase city administrator Kent Myers reportedly sent a letter to a Cameron County commissioner saying the abrupt water cutoff “poses safety and public health risks.”

Starbase “has neither the legal authority nor operational capacity to deliver water to these residents,” Myers said.

Meanwhile, SpaceX has reportedly distributed an “unconditional and perpetual agreement” to non-SpaceX affiliated homes that would exchange access to Starbase’s water and sewer system for residents’ agreement to leave the area for “any and all launch, testing and other operational activities.”

The document also states that “SpaceX has no obligation to provide residents with access to SpaceX’s water and wastewater treatment,” nor does it guarantee the quality or volume of water and

blocks residents from seeking “legal or monetary recourse” against the company.

A city — with no utilities

The newly incorporated city of Starbase, governed by SpaceX executives, is a separate municipal entity adjacent to and encompassing SpaceX’s sprawling South Texas launch site.

[The city was incorporated in May.](#) Only registered voters within the proposed boundary were allowed to vote on the incorporation. There were 247 lots inside that boundary, and only 10 were not owned by SpaceX, according to an affidavit submitted by SpaceX senior manager of spaceport operations Richard Cardile.

Even before the vote was cast, SpaceX had been working behind the scenes to formalize potable water provisions for employees and residents.

SpaceX established a state-regulated drinking-water system, replete with a half-a-million-gallon ground storage tank, plus service pumps, a chlorine analyzer, tank mixer, and other hardware, according to TCEQ records. The central water system, which is supplied by the two water haulers, is small compared to a city utility, but sizable for an on-site, industrial operation. It serves 239 residential service connections, or meters, which can include multiple units.

Starbase’s role is limited by design: “The City of Starbase does not provide any utility services,” Myers told TechCrunch. “These services are provided by SpaceX within the City Limits.”

In practice, that means the forthcoming Brownsville-Starbase pipeline would feed a private, SpaceX-run water system. Neighbors don’t

automatically gain a right to a tap; any connection would be at SpaceX's discretion, and on SpaceX's terms.

The planned pipeline solves near-term scarcity for SpaceX employees and their families but doesn't create a public right to water.

According to public records, SpaceX has not obtained a Certificate of Convenience and Necessity (CCN), a Texas Public Utility Commission authorization that determines who may retail water, so has no obligation to serve third parties.

SpaceX did not respond to TechCrunch's questions on whether it will be adding public utilities to its long list of commercial services.

Topics: [Space](#) [SpaceX](#) [starbase](#)



Aria Alamalhodaei

Reporter, Space and Defense | [X](#)

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